Making Room for Other People

Whose good is missing from what I want?

READING

Seneca, *Letters* 48.1–3; **Marcus Aurelius, *Meditations* 5.6**. Seneca links friendship with shared interests. Marcus separates helping from keeping account of what others owe. We examine whom our desires include and what return we require.

BEFORE THE MEETING

Announce on your Substack. Invite members to notice a shared decision where their preference affects someone else. Include a reading link; preparation is optional.

Open · 10	Read · 10	Discuss · 45	Practice · 15	Close · 10
Optional April observation	Aloud, together	The questions below	Widen a meeting-time preference	One takeaway each

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. In a shared choice, whose interests do you include — and whose are easy to overlook?
2. What would you hope for an overlooked person if someone close to you were in their place?
3. How could taking those interests seriously change what you want, even if your preference remains?
4. When you contribute, what recognition are you waiting for before it feels worthwhile?
5. If someone declines your help, can their welfare remain important without their compliance?

PRACTICE THIS MONTH

Give the want a wider aim. Before one shared choice, name your preference and an overlooked legitimate interest, then finish: **"I want ___ while taking ___ seriously."** Keep that concern without praise or agreement. No extra good deed is required.

FACILITATOR'S MOVE

"Who else is affected?" Include someone who bears a cost without being present. Fair concern includes your own legitimate needs; it does not guarantee a compromise.

NOTES